

DEWDROP

Written by

Levi Zigza

FADE IN:

INT. OLD THEATRE STAGE - NIGHT - DREAM SEQUENCE

A single spotlight pierces the darkness. From high above in the rigging, a water drop gathers, falls through the beam, and flashes electric-blue as it hits the stage.

Heavy curtains swish open.

A figure in a COBALT-BLUE SUIT steps into the spotlight, face obscured, He straightens an old Hollywood vanity mirror, checks the angle, then exits.

Heavy velvet curtains swish open stage left.

DETECTIVE #1 (20s, Asian, wearing an orange Hong Kong police tunic with a cartoonish moustache) saunters on stage, miming a cigarette light.

DETECTIVE #2 (20s, blonde, same orange tunic, matching moustache) follows, taps his shoulder. He snaps open a beat-up metal cigarette case - inside a spectrum of coloured cigarettes. He plucks a white and black stick and hands it to her. She places both between her lips, exhaling grey-and-midnight smoke.

DETECTIVE #2 points offscreen into the dark auditorium.

JASON (V.O.)
Always the same dream... the
theatre... the drop...

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. JUNKYARD RIDGE - NIGHT - DREAM SEQUENCE

The pointing arm now belongs to JASON-TEEN, who snaps it back and joins formation with four other TEEN SLEUTHS on a scrap-metal mound. Each wears vibrant 90s streetwear, snapping magnifying glasses to their eyes in unison:

JASON-TEEN (18, Asian, orange bomber jacket)

ANNALISE-TEEN (17, blonde, lavender accents)

MARCUS-TEEN (17, Black, green hoodie)

PRIYA-TEEN (18, Indian, teal accessories)

Below them a terrified ALEX (19) sits on a rusted car bench, wrists zip-tied, wearing a cheap white mask.

The teens stand frozen. Jason-Teen raises three fingers, dropping them one by one

ONE -- sneakers scrape, everyone pivots.

TWO -- magnifiers snap to eyes.

THREE -- they strike their most dramatic detective pose.

Annalise holds her pose but looks uncertain.

Police sirens blare. Floodlights erupt as cruisers crest the ridge.

The teens turn toward the glare as OFFICER RODRIGUEZ (30s, weary) emerges with a resigned head-shake.

The lights transform into harsh daylight. --

EXT. CEMETERY - DAY - DREAM SEQUENCE

The police lights morph into harsh, grey daylight. Rain falls. Jason-Teen looks lost beside a fresh grave.

His friends stand near him, arms half-extended in comfort but not quite touching him. Officer Rodriguez keeps a respectful distance.

Through mist and rain, the figure in the Cobalt-Suit stands at the cemetery gate, holding a black umbrella, watching Jason-Teen.

Jason-Teen's eyes widen with uneasy recognition as the image burns to white.

MATCH FLASH TO:

INT. CHEN FAMILY LIVING ROOM - DAY - FLASHBACK

Black and white. Documentary-style. A clock ticks loudly.

YOUNG JASON (12) nervously presents a school paper to FATHER CHEN.

CLOSE ON: A clear B+ grade.

Father Chen gives a cold, disapproving look, pointing towards a display of top grades and trophies. Jason wilts.

Father Chen rises, selects a large wooden spoon from the kitchen.

Jason's eyes flash with terror before he bolts.

The chase unfolds in predator/prey style - Mother Chen appears briefly, a frozen silhouette, unable to intervene.

Father Chen corners Jason. The wooden spoon raises high--

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. UNCLE DAVID'S WORKSHOP - DAY - PRESENT

Dust particles dance in a shaft of light. Tools hang neatly on walls, unfinished projects frozen in time. Jason(29, disheveled, haunted) stands inside, having pried open the door.

His eyes land on a blue ceramic vase. He reaches out, fingers brushing its surface.

CERAMIC CHIME -- FLASH: UNCLE DAVID'S hand steadies the same vase. Warm light. Uncle David smiles faintly off-screen.

BACK TO:

Jason pulls his hand back as if burned.

INT. ANNALISE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A projector stutters blue light across Jason's face. On the wall: "THE DEWDROP KILLER."

Jason's EVIDENCE BOARD - newspaper clippings about Uncle David's death, maps of Chinatown, blurry photos. A polaroid shows Young Jason and Uncle David at their secret project base. Overdue bills addressed to Jason are pinned nearby.

Jason stands frozen mid-lecture, twisted grin fading to sorrow.

ANNALISE (38, sharp, weary) sits at the kitchen table, laptop open.

CLOSE ON SCREEN: A manuscript titled "Glass Walls."

Her phone RINGS - UNKNOWN NUMBER - she ignores it, torn between the call and Jason.

JASON (V.O.)
(disoriented)
Where....? When....? Always end up
here... alone...

Annalise snaps her journal shut inches from Jason's face.

ANNALISE

You drifted off again -- new lead, remember? That phone call might have been Ms. Davies, the publisher. It was scheduled for ten minutes ago. You alright?

Jason blinks, he shakes his head with a forced brightness.

JASON

Totally fine -- sorry. Brain lag. You know how my head can be sometimes. Davies? Oh, right. Reschedule. This is bigger.

She eyes him - the tension of someone who's asked too many times.

ANNALISE

(with edge)

Your face changed again--that look I've seen before. You know, J, if you ever want to talk--

JASON

(cutting in quickly)

Later. Dewdrop--he's back.

He flicks a sealed envelope theatrically. Annalise glances at her manuscript, closes her laptop with quiet resignation.

ANNALISE

(skeptical)

Walk me through it.

JASON

Element--

A clattering interrupts. QUINTEN WEBER (16, perpetual scowl) emerges with cereal, eyeing Jason's presentation.

QUINTEN

Great. The unemployed Sherlock Holmes hour, brought to you by my mom's dwindling bank account.

ANNALISE

(sharp whisper)

Quinten. Enough.

JASON
(Ignoring the jab, forcing
a smile)
Good one, Q! Sharp as ever. But
Dewdrop sent a letter!

QUINTEN
(to Annalise)
Mom, I need twenty bucks for the
field trip tomorrow.

ANNALISE
We talked about this. I don't get
paid until Friday.

QUINTEN
(pointed glance at Jason)
Maybe ask your tenant. He's only
what, three months behind?

JASON
(deflecting with a
chuckle)
Working on it, Q! Big break's
coming!

Jason tears open the envelope dramatically.

JASON (CONT'D)
As I was saying. Elementary, my
dear Annalise....

He dramatically paces toward the whiteboard. Blue light
spills from the projector, catching on a wooden spoon on the
counter and the vanity mirror from his dream.

JASON (V.O.)
(fleeting thought)
The mirror... from the dream...
It's real...

CRITICAL VOICE (V.O.)
(sighs dramatically)
It means you're missing something
obvious. Again. Right in front of
your face. Honestly.

QUINTEN
(snorts)
Yeah I'm sure attempt number one
thousand to catch this imaginary
guys is gonna work.

ANNALISE
(warning tone)
QUINTEN! Kitchen table. Now.

Quinten rolls his eyes, slouches to the table. Jason snatches the spoon off the counter and pockets it.

Jason dusts imaginary makeup on his cheeks, blows it off, checks an invisible monitor.

JASON
(startled whisper)
Wait-- we're rolling? Why does
nobody ever fucking warn me?!

Jason whips the chair around, locking into an exaggerated news anchor posture with a ready grin.

INT. NEWSROOM/ANNALISE'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

Same room, different angle. Jason looms as a desk anchor behind a stack of case files.

JASON
(anchor voice)
Hello, I'm Jason Chen reporting to
you live. We've got some breaking
news as we have reason to believe
the Dewdrop killer has resurfaced
to enact the final part of his
master plan after a decades long
hiatus from his heinous criminal
activities. Our man on location has
a letter left behind by this
menace.

He swivels out of the chair and stands upright using a wooden spoon as a microphone.

JASON (CONT'D)
(field voice)
Thanks, Jason. I'm also Jason,
reporting to you live from an
undisclosed corner of the same
apartment that smells suspiciously
like day-old pizza-- hard hitting
journalism at it's finest if you
ask me. Now for the first act of
his final performan he says and I
quote.

He flashes the letter.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (field voice)
 "Where stone lions guard memories
 of home, seek the shop where
 stories sleep in foreign tongues.
 Third shelf from the window, behind
 glass dragons- What falls but never
 breaks, reflects but never speaks?

Jason's pointer traces stone lions to a photo of Centre
 Street Bridge Lions on his board.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (anchor voice)
 Stone Lions - Centre Street Bridge.
 Foreign Tongues - Chinatown
 Bookstore. Colour me intrigued.
 Jason. Any intel on this so-called
 third shelf?

JASON (CONT'D)
 (field voice)
 Sources tell us it's the third
 shelf at Mr. Wong's Book Emporium --
 just under the glass dragon
 everybody pretends not to notice.
 (glances back)
 Also, I must say looking sharp
 tonight, Jason.

Jason winks at the empty chair, sitting back down.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (anchor voice)
 Right back at you, you handsome
 devil. Now I've been told that this
 place holds some significance for
 you. Please enlighten us.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (field voice)
 Why yes it does. I once mistook the
 janitors closet for the little boys
 room. Turns out that little yellow
 bucket is not a portable urinal. As
 embarrassing as it was I knew I
 needed to make the journalistic
 sacrifice so that that you.
 (dramatic pause)
 The public.
 (dramatic pause)
 Can be in the know.

CERAMIC CLINK -- FLASH: A perfect blue droplet slides down the vanity mirror frame.

BACK TO:

Jason frowns, momentarily distracted.

His focus shifts and he scrutinizes Chinese characters on the letter, placing it on the table.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (field voice - whisper)
 According to our in-house linguist -
 - me, with two half-forgotten
 semesters of Saturday Cantonese
 that ended with my dad saying 'Neih
 hou lan ah!' (You're terrible!)--
 they say "sly little thief" and
 "dripping faucet." Odd clues, but
 until Eddie--the actually fluent
 one-- chimes in, we'll call it
 journalism in progress.

Jason drops the act. Annalise has been recording on her phone with a forced smile. Quinten looks thoroughly unimpressed.

JASON (CONT'D)
 (sheepish)
 Too much?

ANNALISE
 (noncommittal)
 It was... a performance.

He straightens, slipping into a detective posture.

JASON
 (detective voice)
 My dear Annalise - the game is
 afoot! Calgary's streets whisper
 clues, and every genius needs his
 trusty field partner. Will you
 accompany me?

ANNALISE
 (sighs, glancing at her
 laptop)
 Look, J, I'd love to--but I've got
 copy edits due, bills piling up,
 and I need to reschedule that call
 with Ms. Davies. Plus, Quinten
 needs a ride to school. And you
 need to call about the job lead I
 gave you.

JASON

(dismissive)

Come on--adventure waits for no car-pool. Or publisher calls! This is the break!

QUINTEN

(disgusted)

Just go with him, Mom. Not like you listen when I tell you he needs actual help, not enabling.

ANNALISE

(To Quinten, sharper)

That's enough.

(to Jason, reluctant smile)

One hour. After I drop Quinten off. Then I'm back to real life. My real life. My deadlines.

Jason salutes with the spoon-mic, grinning manically. His eyes briefly flick to the vanity mirror, then away.

INT. ANNALISE'S APARTMENT - LATER MORNING

The front door closes. Jason stands alone.

He wanders to the window, watching the quiet Calgary street. Morning light catches the dust particles. He pulls out a old tape player, he also pulls out a case of different colored tapes. All of the tape slots are full except for one. He inputs a tape with yellow labelling. A dreamy instrumental begins.

Jason closes his eyes and moves into the centre of the room. Not quite dancing, just swaying - arms extending, turning, a physical release. His eyes closed, lost in the moment.

For this brief moment, there are no internal voices. Just Jason, the music, and the light.

His eyes open mid-spin and catch his reflection in the dark tv screen. He stops abruptly, spell broken. He studies his reflection - a weary stranger staring back. A faint, almost imperceptible flicker of cobalt blue appears behind his reflection.

He pulls out the earbuds, cutting off the music.

JASON
(muttering)
Chinatown... Third shelf... Got to
focus.

He grabs his jacket, about to leave, then pauses. Looks around the messy apartment and sighs. Starts tidying a small corner almost automatically, straightening the vanity mirror against the shelf.

INT. GROCERY STORE - DAY (MICRO-SCENE)

Bright fluorescent lights. Jason stands in a aisle, staring blankly at a shelf of instant noodles. His breathing becomes shallow.

JASON'S POV: The colorful packages seem to pulse. Vision edges blur.

ANXIOUS VOICE (V.O.)
(whispering)
Too bright... Too many choices...
Can't breathe... They're
watching...

He grips the cart handle, knuckles white. A nearby shopper glances at him.

SHOPPER
Excuse me, are you okay?

Jason jumps, startled, forcing a tight smile.

JASON
Fine. Just... deciding.

He abruptly abandons his cart and walks out quickly.

EXT. CALGARY STREET - LATER MORNING

Jason steps out of the apartment building, checking his phone for the time. Ahead, an elderly Chinese woman (Po Po, 70s) struggles with heavy grocery bags.

One bag slips, apples rolling onto the sidewalk. Jason stops, watching. His usual distracted energy pauses.

He walks over, kneels down, gathers the rolling apples, and places them back in her bag. He lifts both heavy bags up the steps, setting them inside her building's doorway.

Po Po looks surprised, then smiles warmly, bowing her head in gratitude. Jason offers a small, genuine smile back. After her door closes, he stands there for a beat, lost in the moment.

Suddenly, he checks his phone and his eyes widen in panic. He breaks into a frantic run toward Chinatown.

EXT. CALGARY CHINATOWN GATE - DAY

Jason runs up, breathless, to where Annalise waits impatiently by her parked car,. Stone lions surround the gate.

Annalise checks her watch pointedly.

ANNALISE

You're ten minutes late, J. I said one hour. That hour started ten minutes ago. My hour.

JASON

(catching breath)

Sorry, sorry... Got... held up. Lost track. You know how it is.

ANNALISE

(unconvinced)

Yeah. I know how it is. Clock's ticking. Let's go. Mr. Wong's.

JASON

Right. Mr. Wong's book emporium... Uncle David used to bring me here... Showed me all the old detective stories...

He pulls out his tape case and replaces the previous tape with a new one that has green labelling. He puts his earbuds in and fumbles with the buttons.

ANNALISE

(walking ahead)

Seriously? You still use that thing?

JASON

It holds... important files. Helps me focus.

Faint, tinny audio leaks - Uncle David's voice:

UNCLE DAVID (FILTERED V.O.)
 ... Little Detective sees
 everything others miss... your
 gift, Like Chow Yun-fat in Hard
 Boiled...

Jason takes a deep breath, centered momentarily. He pockets the player.

INT. MR. WONG'S BOOK EMPORIUM - DAY

Modest storefront, dusty windows filled with stacks of Chinese newspapers and books.

CRAMPED. Floor-to-ceiling shelves packed tight. MR. WONG sits behind a cluttered counter, barely looking up as Jason and Annalise enter. The air smells of old paper and incense.

JASON
 (hesitant Cantonese)
 Wong Sifu, hou noi mou gin. (Mr.
 Wong, long time no see)

MR. WONG
 (looks up briefly, replies
 in Cantonese)
 Aiyah, Jason jai. Haih ah. Neih jou
 mat yeh? (Aiyah, young Jason. Yes.
 What are you doing?)

JASON
 (switches to English)
 Just looking for something. For
 a... project.

MR. WONG
 (Nods, goes back to
 reading, mutters in
 Cantonese) Dōu haih gong
 di mouh jung ge
 yeh. (Always talking about
 useless things) Tourists
 mostly buy trinkets now.
 Nobody reads real books.
 Only watch those silly
 little shows... Like that
 Kim's one.

ANNALISE
 (To Jason, quiet)
 Charming.

Jason ignores her, already scanning the layout. His eyes dart around, trying to orient himself.

JASON
(muttering)
Okay, okay... Riddle said... 'Where
stone lions guard
memories...' Bridge... 'shop here
stories sleep in foreign
tongues...' Here. 'Third
shelf'... 'Glass dragon'... South
wall... Which way is south...?

<< SUBJECTIVE POV SEQUENCE START >>

JASON'S POV: The bookstore warps. Sounds distort - newspaper crackling becomes crackling fire, the bell jingle echoes unnaturally. Colors bleed at the edges. Focus pulses.

JASON (V.O.)
Okay. South wall. Find the dragon
first. Then count three shelves
down.

His gaze sweeps the shelves. They seem to stretch and compress.

ANXIOUS VOICE (V.O.)
He's watching. Wong. He knows
you're weird. Knows you're broken.
Annalise is watching too. Waiting
for you to screw up. You're late.
She's already mad...

DISTRACTED VOICE (V.O.)
That incense... Sandalwood? Or
Jasmine? Reminds me of...
something... Temple? Grandma's? Why
can't I place it?

He bumps into a display of calligraphy brushes, sending a few clattering.

MR. WONG (O.S. - CANTONESE)
Aiyah! Siu Sam di! (Aiyah! Be
careful!)

Jason jumps. Pov whips to Mr. Wong, whose face seems momentarily distorted, accusatory.

JASON (V.O. - PANIC/PROCESS)
Shit. Okay. Sorry. Just looking.
South wall.... South wall...
(MORE)

JASON (V.O. - PANIC/PROCESS) (CONT'D)
Where's the damn dragon? Gotta see
the dragon...

Jason scans frantically. He spots it - high on a shelf, the ugly 'Glass Dragon.'

JASON (V.O.)
There. South wall. Dragon. Now...
thirds shelf down.

His POV zooms, hyper-focusing on the third shelf. Time slows. Only the spines on this shelf are clear. His fingers trace them, trembling.

ANXIOUS VOICE (V.O.)
It won't be there. It's a trick.
Another dead end.

His fingers find a slim volume bound in faded blue cloth. No title on the spine.

JASON (V.O.)
Blue... like the dream... like the
drop...

BACK TO NORMAL VIEW:

Jason holds the slim blue book, breathing heavily. Annalise approaches.

ANNALISE
Find something? Or just trying to
read the spines with your psychic
powers?

JASON
(transfixed)
This is it. I know it.

He opens the book carefully. Pressed between the middle pages is a single, faded polaroid photo.

INSERT - POLAROID PHOTO: Uncle David stands smiling, arm around YOUNG JASON (10). They're in front of a slightly decaying building. Written below: "Our Secret Project Base - DJ".

Jason stares at the photo, confusion replacing triumph. His reflection warps slightly in a nearby display case.

JASON (CONT'D)
I... I don't remember this. This
photo. This place... But...

CRITICAL VOICE (V.O.)

(mocking)

What? Gaps in the memory? Shocking.

Suddenly, Jason's nose starts bleeding. A drop falls onto the photo, landing near Uncle David's face. The blood looks strangely blue-tinged in the dim light.

Jason doesn't notice, lost in the photo he flips through the book again and finds a thin slip of paper hidden between pages. He holds it to the light. Faint writing appears.

INSERT - SLIP OF PAPER:

"Five once gathered where forgotten things find rest, behind walls marked with chalk eyes that see all secrets. Follow tracks where metal sleeps beneath the moon. What grows stronger in darkness yet fears the light?"

ANNALISE

(noticing the blood)

J! Your nose! Are you okay?

She reaches for him, concerned. Jason waves her off, staring at the building in the photo.

JASON

Secret project base... We have to got there. Now.

ANNALISE

(checking watch)

Jason, my hour is definitely up. And that riddle points to the old junkyard hideout, nowhere near this building.

JASON

(desperate, grabbing her arm)

Please, Lise. Just drive me there. To the building in the photo. Drop me off.

ANNALISE

Okay. But I'm just dropping you. Then I'm gone. Deal?

JASON

(nodding rapidly)

Deal.

INT. ANNALISE'S CAR - DAY

Annalise drives tensely. Jason stares out the window, clutching the book and photo. Rain begins falling, streaking the windshield. Thunder cracks faintly.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
(whispery)
Jason... boundaries..

Jason flinches, rubs his temples.

ANNALISE
You okay? Headache?

JASON
(waving it off)
Fine. Just... thinking.

He stares out at the rain, the whispered warning echoing.

INT. ANNALISE'S CAR - LATER

Jason stares out the window, lost in memory.

JASON (V.O.)
We were good... For a while...
Before...

CRITICAL VOICE
(Scoffs, escalating)
Good? You were kids playing dress-up! Led them right into disaster. Remember the sting? Remember what really happened? FAILURE!

SMASH CUT TO:

FLASHBACK - TEEN FORMATION MONTAGE (QUICKENED)

Quick cuts, vibrant saturated colors, energetic indie music.

- Jason-Teen (Orange bomber) sketching in the library corner.

- Connor-Teen (Sage hoodie) showing Marcus-Teen (Blue beanie) a laptop in AV club. Priya-Teen (Teal Jewelry) organizes cables.

- Jason bumps into the other teens in the cafeteria, spilling an energy drink. They help clean up as he launches into some conspiracy theories he's heard. The 4 get transfixed by his story.

- The five teens hangout in Connor's basement. Jason shows printouts from online forums, tries teaching confrontation poses.
- A community safety alert poster appears in the school hallways. Jason shows it to the others, linking it to something he saw online.
- MONTAGE: The five start investigating a bake sale theft - Jason's fingerprint powder makes a mess, a tripwire catches a teacher, Priya finds evidence leading to the janitor's closet.
- The team confronts a grumpy JANITOR, they feel triumphant.
- The five walk together, laughing. Officer Rodrigues gives a warning headshake but smiles slightly.
- Basement hangout. Bottle flipping contest for Lead Detective. Jason wins narrowly, looking surprised and pleased.

INT. CONNOR'S BASEMENT - NIGHT

The teens hunched over a laptop. Multiple chat windows open. Jason points at a profile - ALEX (19)

JASON-TEEN

(whispering excitedly)

Guys, look! This dude, Alex.
Nineteen. His whole vibe is off.
Look at this message he sent Priya -
"Meet up later? Got something
special for you." Total creep!

Priya-Teen looks uncomfortable, showing her phone screen.

PRIYA-TEEN

I don't know J.. He seems harmless?
Maybe a bit awkward... But sweet..
He's a big fan of "Mortal
Oathbreakers" like me. He even
offered to lend me their CD...

CONNOR-TEEN

(analyzing the screen)

Nah, look at his profile pics. His
bio "Always lurking". And that
username "Nightcrawler 82? Seems
sketch! Plus, check the timestamp -
he was near the park when that
kid's bike went missing!

MARCUS-TEEN

If J's right we could be like Franz Jansan from "To Catch a Scumbag". We could totally sting him! For justice! Maybe we could even end up on tv.

ANNALISE-TEEN

(More forcefully)

Justice? Or fame? J, are we sure about this? He literally just offered Priya a CD. What if he's just lonely? Setting someone up based on a username and coincidental location... what if we're wrong?

JASON-TEEN

(dismissive)

This is different, Lise! You're just scared. This is real danger! We have a duty! Priya, you have to keep chatting him up. Tell him you'll meet him for the CD. Tomorrow night at the old junkyard - It's isolated, a perfect ambush spot. Connor, cameras ready. Marcus, zip ties. We're gonna be heroes. This is our moment!

Priya looks down, conflicted but she nods reluctantly. Annalise looks unconvinced but is outnumbered. Connor starts prepping camera gear.

CUT TO:

EXT. JUNKYARD - NIGHT (DIFFERENT FROM DREAM)

The teens hide amongst scrap heaps, phones recording. Connor-Teen has a camera setup. Priya-Teen waits nervously as bait.

Headlights approach. Alex (19) gets out, looking uncertain, holding a small CD case.

ALEX

(calling hesitantly)

Priya? You here? I made you a mixtape...

Jason-Teen gives the signal. The teens burst out, surrounding Alex, phones thrust forward.

JASON-TEEN
(shouting)
Alright, creep! Hands up!

Alex looks bewildered, dropping the CD case.

ALEX
What? Who are you guys? Where's
Priya? What's going on? I made a
mixtape for her.

MARCUS-TEEN
(moving with zip ties)
Save it, perv! We got you on
camera!

They clumsily grab Alex.

ALEX
Don't touch me! What is this?!

Jason-Teen slaps the white mask on his face. Annalise hangs
back, horrified.

Sirens blare. Police cruisers pull in, lights flashing.
Officer Rodriguez steps out, furious

OFFICER RODRIGUEZ
(via megaphone)
EVERYBODY FREEZE! CALGARY POLICE!
Hands up where I can see them.

The teens freeze. Rodriguez approaches Jason, face grim.

OFFICER RODRIGUEZ (CONT'D)
Jason. What in God's name do you
and your little group think you're
doing? Assault? Unlawful
confinement? Vigilantism? You kids
watch too much tv.

He moves towards Alex and pulls the mask off him. He's
visibly upset. The teens look stunned. Annalise horrified.
Priya mortified. Marcus confused. Connor lowers his camera.

OFFICER RODRIGUEZ (CONT'D)
(To other officers)
Get their information. Call their
parents.
(To Alex)
Are you okay? Do you want to press
charges?

Alex shakes his head, overwhelmed.

ALEX
No.. I just.. I wanna go home.

OFFICER RODRIGUEZ
(to teens, voice
dangerously low)
You're all getting a ride home
tonight. And you can explain this
mess to your parents. Especially
you, Jason. I thought you learned
your lesson after the Henderson
incident.

INT. JASON'S TEENAGE BEDROOM - NIGHT

(BLACK AND WHITE)

Jason sits on his bed. FATHER CHEN stands over him, cold
fury. He holds a police incident report.

FATHER CHEN
(In Cantonese, low and
dangerous)
Wui ging chaak... Yauh haih neih...
Diu leuhn gaahn! (Police... Again
because of you.. Bringing shame!)

He crumples the police report slowly, deliberately.

FATHER CHEN (CONT'D)
(Coldly, in Cantonese)
Yiu uauh hau gwo. (There must be
consequences.)

He walks to a closet, returns holding a thick wooden belt.

Jason scrambles off the bed, backing away in terror.

Father Chen advances.

The belt raises high--

CLOSE ON JASON'S FACE: As the sound of the belt whistles
through the air, Jason's expression goes distant, his eyes
begin to unfocus.

<< DISSOCIATION EFFECT STARTS >>

Visuals: B&W image degrades - increased static, rolling.
Focus drifts heavily.

SOUND: The crack of the belt hitting is muffled, replaced by
static.

CRITICAL VOICE (V.O. DISTORTED)
 Failure... danger... disgrace...
 worthless.. unlovable...
 defective... I deserve this...

Jason's face remains blank as the sounds of the beating continue, muffle and unreal.

<< DISSOCIATION EFFECT END >>

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SCHOOLYARD - DAY (LATER)

Jason-Teen approaches his friends as they huddle together avoiding eye contact.

JASON-TEEN
 Hey guys. So, Officer Rodriguez just gave us a warning, right? We can lay low for a bit, then maybe look into that missing cat on Elm Street.--

CONNOR-TEEN
 (interrupting sharply)
 Are you serious, J? Lay low? My parents almost sent me to military school! They took my decks! We could have been charged!

PRIYA-TEEN
 (voice trembling)
 My parents were so pissed. They said I can't hang out with you anymore. I can't believe I did that too poor Alex... he looked so scared, and he wanted to do such a kind thing for me. J. We were wrong. You were wrong. You just kept pushing like you always do.

MARCUS-TEEN
 (shuffling feet)
 Yeah, man. My dad said one more screw-up and I'm working full-time at his garage. This was nothing like the bake sale. All cause we followed you.

Jason looks at Annalise-Teen, desperate for support. She finally meet his gaze - disappointment, fear, pity.

ANNALISE-TEEN

My Dad freaked out, J. He talked about lawyers. He said you're reckless. That you don't see the consequences. And... I did try to tell you, J. I really did. But you don't listen when you get like this. I can't do this anymore. It's too much. I'm out.

JASON-TEEN

(voice cracking)

Out? But... the team! We were doing good!

CONNOR-TEEN

We almost assaulted someone, J! That's not good! We gotta step back. For real this time. Sorry dude.

The group disperses quickly, leaving Jason standing alone.

CRITICAL VOICE (V.O.)

See? Reckless. Dangerous. You push too hard. You break everything. Everyone leaves. Alone... Always alone.

Jason looks down at a puddle and walks away. A neon sign flickers in the puddle, the reflection briefly morphs.

INT. STYLIZED ALLEYWAY - NIGHT

Pouring rain. Neon lights reflect on slick pavement. Exaggerated shadows.

DETECTIVE #1 and DETECTIVE #2 creep along the wall, moving with jerky, comedic stealth.

The Cobalt-Blue Suit figure darts across the far end, disappearing around a corner.

The Detectives exchange determined nods and give chase.

They reach the corner, peer around cautiously. The street is empty.

Detective #1 spots something sparkling - a blue cufflink lies beside a shard of blue ceramic with gold-traced edge.

He pockets both items. They square shoulders, adjust hats and sprint deeper into the night.

INT. CHEN FAMILY DINING ROOM - NIGHT (CHILDHOOD)

Steam rises from a bubbling hot pot. The room is warm, filled with chopstick clatter and Cantonese conversation.

Present: YOUNG JASON (10) YOUNG EDDIE (11). FATHER CHEN, MOTHER CHEN, UNCLE DAVID.

FOCUS: Hands dipping food, steam obscuring faces, thinly sliced meat, mushrooms, greens.

Father Chen talks to Eddie in Cantonese, discussing schoolwork, placing choice pieces in Eddie's bowl.

FATHER CHEN

Eddie ah, gei dak jou gung fo ah.
Yiu yap hou daaih hok. (Eddie,
remember to do homework. Need to
get into good university.)

MOTHER CHEN

Sihk do di la (Eat more.)

She tends the pot, offering worried glances at Jason.

Uncle David sits beside Jason. He playfully steals a fish ball from Jason's bowl, replaces it with a better piece of meat, winking.

UNCLE DAVID

(whispering)

See that one? Looks like the bad
guy from A Better Tomorrow, eh?
Always hiding.

Young Jason smiles, engaged. Eddie looks slightly annoyed. Father Chen ignores Jason and focuses on Eddie.

FATHER CHEN

(to Uncle David, sharp, in
Cantonese) David, m'hou
jou laahn di sihk gaan
laa. (Jason needs focus.
Not silly stories.)

Uncle David smiles, unfazed, giving Jason another wink.

EXT. ABANDONED BUILDING - DAY

Annalise pulls up near the building from the polaroid. Jason gets out, still clutching his findings.

ANNALISE

My hour was up ages ago. This place looks ready to collapse. Have fun.

JASON

(distracted)

Yeah, thanks. I'll be fine.

Annalise drives away. Jason faces the secret project base alone.

INT. ABANDONED BUILDING - DAY

Dust particles dance in shafts of light. Jason walks cautiously through decaying rooms, flashlight beam cutting through the gloom.

JASON (V.O.)

Secret project base... What were we doing here? Why don't I remember?

He enters an office. Papers litter the floor. His flashlight catches something wedged behind a loose baseboard.

He pries it loose - another small, folded slip of paper. He carefully unfolds it.

INSERT - SLIP OF PAPER: "In the house where time stops and whispers echo grief, seek the room where blue flowers never die. Third doorway from the eastern wall holds silent belief. What is always coming but never arrives?"

Jason pockets the new riddle and leaves the building.

INT. DEANE HOUSE - DAY

Elegant, slightly unsettling atmosphere. Staff quietly prepare for an event. Jason tries to blend in, navigating through the halls.

He passes a large mirror, his reflection seems to flicker momentarily with a hint of cobalt blue. He shakes his head, moving on.

JASON (V.O.)

East wall.... Third door... This one.

He enters a smaller reception room. Sunlight streams through windows. He sees the imprint in the carpet where a casket once rested.

JASON (V.O.)
He was right here... Uncle David...

Two staff members enter with cleaning supplies.

STAFF MEMBER #1
... Make sure everything's cleared out before the wedding party arrives... especially those blue arrangements from last week's service...

STAFF MEMBER #2
Right. They don't want any reminders... Did you find that vase they were asking about? The blue one?

JASON'S POV: Words distort through paranoia. "Cleared out" - "COVER UP." "Blue arrangements" = "DEWDROP." "Blue vase" = "MURDER WEAPON?"

Jason ducks behind chairs. His eyes land on a single, wilted blue blue flower near the baseboard, missed during cleanup.

He carefully picks it up, tucking it away like evidence and walks outside. As he leaves he passes a display case reflecting the street. The street shows mannequins.

INT. STYLIZED DEPARTMENT STORE - NIGHT

Mannequins in noir fashion. Harsh shadows, flickering lights.

Detective #1 and #2 search frantically through suit racks.

Detective #2 holds the blue cufflink and gold-veined shard, comparing them to displays.

They spot the Cobalt-Blue Suit figure examining blue leather gloves across the floor.

He notices them. A chase ensues - dodging mannequins, vaulting counters, running up wrong-way escalators.

The man in blue ducks into a fitting room. The detectives follow, finding it empty except for a blue leather glove on a partially repaired blue kintsugi vase.

Detective #1 snatches the glove. Detective #2 points to a high window, slightly ajar - escape route.

Inside the glove: a small logo - stylized water drop.

INT. GONG CHA BOBA SHOP - DAY (PAST)

Jason (Mid-20s) sits across from YUJIN (similar age, Korean, bright eyes, artistic). Half-finished bubble teas between them. Comfortable silence.

Jason slides a worn sketchbook across the table. Yujin opens it.

VISUAL: The pages flip rapidly, creating a FLIP-BOOK ANIMATION

- Two stick-figures meet at crossroads, question mark bubbles.
- Figures walk side-by-side, helping each other over obstacles.
- They reach a fork - signs: "CAVES" and "JUNGLE".
- Stick Jason gestures toward the caves, Stick Yujin shakes her head, she points toward the jungle. Stick Jason shakes his head.
- They face each other. Sharing a knowing glance, they exchange a hug and each hand the other a small object.
- Stick Jason gives her a compass. Stick Yujin gives him a blue glowing flower.
- Final drawing: Stick Jason, flower in pocket, looks back while on his path watching stick Yujin walk away.

BACK TO:

INT. GONG CHA BOBA SHOP - DAY

Yujin looks up, soft understanding smile. Long moment of connection, regret, acceptance.

She closes the sketchbook, pushes it back to him.

YUJIN
(softly)
It's beautiful, Jason. But... you
know I had to take my path.
(MORE)

YUJIN (CONT'D)

And you.. you need to find yours.
Not just follow ghosts.

He looks down, then up. Yujin's chair is empty. She's gone.

Jason looks around. The shop is emptier now. A young couple laughs quietly at another table.

Jason watches them, complex emotions on his face. He puts cash onto the table and signals to the waiter. He points at himself and then towards the young couple. The waiter gives a knowing nod and smile.

Jason takes his sketchbook and walks out into the rain.

INT. ANNALISE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Jason pins the wilted blue flower to his evidence board with manic intensity. Annalise enters, tired from work. She sets down groceries, sighs at the increased mess, then opens her laptop but just stares at the manuscript.

ANNALISE

(quietly)

Find anything... illuminating at
the funeral home? Besides dead
flowers?

JASON

(defensive)

It's a clue, Lise. Dewdrop was
there. They were talking about a
blue vase...

Annalise closes her laptop turns to face him with controlled anger.

ANNALISE

Jason. Stop. Just.... stop it.
There is no Dewdrop. There is no
conspiracy. There's just you,
drowning, and pulling me and my son
under with you. You know that I'm
happy to shelter you knowing all
you've been through but I missed an
important call today because I was
driving you around chasing riddles.

JASON

What are you talking about? I'm
onto something! That call wasn't
important...

ANNALISE

(voice rising)

No! You're avoiding everything! You haven't looked for a job in months. You missed the rent, again. You haven't asked me a single question about my life - about my book, Jason, the one that could actually change things for us - in god knows how long! Quinten is hiding in his room because he can't stand the tension! That call was with a publisher, Jason! A real lead! You haven't changed at all from high school. And once again I have to suffer the consequences of your impulsive decisions and escapism.

JASON

I'm busy! This is important! More important than....

ANNALISE

(cutting him off,
trembling with rage)

More important than your life? Than our lives? I am so tired, Jason. Tired of playing nice, tired of making excuses for you, tired of watching you chase ghosts while real life burns down around us!

She gestures around the room wildly

ANNALISE (CONT'D)

My mother spent her whole life making herself small so my father wouldn't get angry. Walking on eggshells. Is that what this is? Am I supposed to just... disappear into the background of your obsession? Be the quiet, supportive sidekick while you go off and play detective? Fuck that! I have my own life, my own ambitions!

Jason flinches, genuinely shocked.

JASON

Sidekick? I thought... partner...

ANNALISE

Partners let each other in!
Partners build something together!

(MORE)

ANNALISE (CONT'D)

You? You build walls. These glass walls where you pretend you don't care, but you're terrified underneath! Terrified to let yourself feel anything real - love, hate, grief, joy! You go off into your fantasy land cause you're afraid. You can't handle taking off the mask but you have to embrace the messiness and believe that you have it within you too handle it. You can't just let life happen to you!

Jason looks lost unable to process her raw honesty.

JASON

(quietly, defeated)

Okay. Fine. You're right. I'm a burden. You should leave. Everyone leaves eventually.

This passive acceptance infuriates Annalise more.

ANNALISE

(voice thick with tears)

That's it?! That's your fight?! I don't want to leave! But you give me no choice! You won't let anyone in! You won't even fight for yourself! How can I let Quinten watch this? Watch you just... fade away behind your glass walls. Never willing to take the wheel of your life.

She takes a deep shaky breath.

ANNALISE (CONT'D)

I can't do it anymore. I won't become my mother. I'm choosing me. I'm choosing Quinten. I think... I think you need to find somewhere else to stay. For a while. Until you truly want to break your cycle.

JASON

Ok.

ANNALISE turns away, wiping her eyes, and walks toward Quinten's room. Jason slowly gathers his things - the evidence board contents, the blue book, the photo, the flower. He stands in silence

INT. STYLIZED HALL OF MIRRORS - NIGHT

Detective #1 and #2 navigate a maze of mirrors. They glimpse the Cobalt-Blue Suit Figure in the mirrors, never where the reflections suggest.

The detectives corner the figure at a dead end, facing a large cracked mirror. The man in blue turns slowly. In the reflection, the detectives see the blue ceramic vase. Now whole and laced with gold lines.

The detectives stare at shattered glass, then each other. Detective #1 points toward an implied location. They nod grimly.

INT. GRIMY MOTEL ROOM - DAY

Jason sits on a lumpy bed in a cheap motel. His evidence is spread haphazardly around him. His phone buzzes - an unknown number. A text message notification appears. He hesitantly picks it up.

CLOSE ON PHONE SCREEN: "Heard you were asking about old times. Some oaths don't fade.

Attached is a photo: A reflection in a glass skyscraper, showing a partial figure in a suit inside a modern office.

More text appears: "The loyal one who chose law over loyalty now dwells where glass towers scrape Calgary skies. Floor seventeen, where truth hides behind closed doors."

JASON (V.O.)

Eddie? He knows I'm looking... Is he warning me? Or is he part of it?

Jason uses his phone to call.

JASON

Eddie? It's Jason... I need to ask you something... about Uncle David...

INT. EDDIE'S MODERN OFFICE - CONTINUOUS - INTERCUT

EDDIE CHEN (31, sharp suit) sits behind a large desk juggling multiple phone lines. A half-empty scotch bottle sits nearby.

EDDIE

(impatient)

Jason? Now's not a good time. Uncle David? That was years ago...

(MORE)

EDDIE (CONT'D)
Look, I really can't talk. Dad
needs me to review these
contracts...

He hangs up abruptly, pours scotch into his coffee mug,
drinks deeply.

INT. GRIMY MOTEL ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Jason stares at the dead phone.

JASON
(to himself)
Yeah. Sometime. Maybe.

INT. GRIMY BATHROOM - NIGHT

Cracked tiles, flickering light, water stains. Jason sits on
the edge of the bathtub, utterly defeated.

His eyes drift to a bottle of bleach under the sink. He
stares at it for a long time. The dripping faucet gets louder
in his head. His hand slowly reaches for the bottle.

CRITICAL VOICE
(insidious whisper)
End it. It's the only way out. No
more pain. No more failure. Just...
quiet.

His fingers tighten on the bottle. He starts to life it.

His gaze drifts to his reflection in the cloudy mirror. He
sees the exhaustion, the despair.

He also sees, a flicker of a memory with a trace of Uncle
David's kindness. The reflection ripples slightly.

Jason hesitates. His grip on the bleach bottle loosens.

He sits there for another long moment, the dripping faucet
the only sound.

Then slowly, deliberately, he stands up. He turns on the tap,
splashes cold water on his face. He turns off the dripping
faucet decisively.

He walks out, leaving the bleach bottle untouched.

EXT. CALGARY STREETS - NIGHT

Jason finds an old skateboard leaning against the dumpster. He puts a foot on it and launches himself.

He skates through deserted downtown streets. City lights blur into streaks.

He skates until he's exhausted, stopping under the harsh lights of an underpass, breathing heavily.

INT. GRIMY MOTEL ROOM - NIGHT - LATER

Jason analyzes the riddles, looking for patterns.

JASON (V.O.)
"What falls but never breaks..."
Dewdrop... "What grows stronger in
darkness..." Shadows... "What's
always coming..." Tomorrow..."What
Breaks without
touching..."Words..."

He circles recurring themes across the different papers.
"Memories," "home," "secrets," "truth," "eyes," "blue."

JASON (V.O.)
The mirror... The mirror from the
dream... "Reflects but never
speaks..." A mirror..."Cuts without
touching..." Words... like
reflections.. Return to where walls
held laughter and tears... Home...
Our old house.. Third floorboard...
Uncle David's hiding spot....

He pieces it together - the final clue points to his childhood home. He scrambles to his feet, grabbing his jacket.

EXT. JASON'S CHILDHOOD HOME - NIGHT

A modest suburban house, slightly neglected. Jason approaches, filled with dread and manic energy. He finds a way in through an unlocked window.

INT. JASON'S CHILDHOOD HOME - NIGHT

Dark, silent. Furniture covered in sheets. Jason navigates by flashlight toward his old bedroom.

LEFT SCREEN (JASON'S REALITY):

Jason pushes open his old bedroom door. Moonlight illuminates the dusty room. His flashlight beam sweeps nervously. He looks toward the old hollywood vanity mirror that's propped in a corner. Near the mirror, on a small table, a blue ceramic vase holds dried flowers.

RIGHT SCREEN (STYLIZED REALITY):

Bedroom doors burst open with exaggerated force. Detective #1 tumbles inside alone. He regains composure and draws his toy gun, he looks around the distorted room with determination, focusing on the mirror.

JASON'S REALITY:

Jason steps inside. The air feels heavy. He walks slowly toward the mirror. His reflection looks haunted.

STYLIZED REALITY:

DETECTIVE #1 Creeps toward a mirror, toy gun extended, moving in a low crouch.

THE MIRROR:

Jason stares at his reflection. Suddenly, it changes. It's himself wearing a COBALT-BLUE SUIT, smirking coldly. Jason gasps and stumbles back.

JASON'S REALITY/ STYLIZED BLEED:

The blue suit figure steps out of the mirror, becoming solid in the room. Detective #1 reacts with an exaggerated shock, aiming a toy gun at the figure.

JASON
(whispering, terrified)
No... It's over.. Dewdrop...

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE
(Chuckles softly. Jason's
voice. Smooth and
detached)
Dewdrop. Cute. Took you long enough
to look in the mirror.

JASON
(voice shaking)
Who... who are you? What is this?
The riddles...? Uncle...? Did you
hurt him?

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE
 (tilts head, considering)
 Hurt him? I protected you. From the
 truth. From your own weakness.

Jason's eyes dart around the familiar room, landing on the third floorboard near the wall - Uncle David's old hiding spot. Dewdrop nods toward it.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE (CONT'D)
 Go on. Look. See what other truths
 you buried.

Jason scrambles to the floorboard, he pries it open.

Inside: Blue Gloves, Cufflink, and a small tape with blue labelling.

Jason stares, horrified recognition dawning. He inserts the tape into his recorder, fingers trembling he presses play.

CRITICAL VOICE (ON TAPE)
 (Jason's own voice,
 distorted, harsh)
 ...pathetic...failure...worthless..

Jason drops the recorder as if burned. He look at his hands, then at Dewdrop, the understanding comes crashing down.

JASON
 It was... It was me? All along?

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE
 (nods slowly, cold
 satisfaction)
 The control you needed. The
 judgment you deserved. The
 performance.

FLASHBACK - DEWDROP ORIGIN (Quick intercut with Jason's realization)

- B&W footage of wooden spoon aftermath. Young Jason hiding in closet.

- First emergence: Young Jason staring into vanity mirror, tears streaming. Reflection shifts, becoming calmer, colder.

- Guiding hand: Gloved hand (Dewdrop's) guiding Young Jason's hand drawing the blue dewdrop symbol on a foggy window.

- Recording the Voice: Dewdrop/Jason speaking into into a tape recorder, capturing harsh V.O.

Evolution.

- Flashes showing persona solidifying.
- Using detachment to cope with Father's criticism
- Twisting detective stories into a personal myth
- Preparing riddles, planting clues while Jason dissociates.

JASON

(whispering)

Why...? Uncle David.. What happened?

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE

(Steps closer, voice calm, almost reasonable)

He saw your cracks early and he was going to make a phone call to get you some real professional help. He saw how much the past weighed on you. But you thought he was punishing you. You couldn't handle that the only person who ever showed you kindness and love could send you away just like everyone else. And when he tried to comfort you. Don't you remember. The push. The accident.

Flash: Uncle David falls and hits head on a post and bleeds out. The blue vase visible nearby, knocked over but not directly involved.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE (CONT'D)

You panicked. Even if it was an accident. You couldn't handle the guilt. So, I handled it. Made it neat. Gave them a nice little sob story. A fall down the stairs. Plausible, a better story than the messy truth. I protected you. I shielded you. We could have buried this. My burden to bear. But for some reason you and your little detective friend couldn't help but keep digging. So, I said okay if you want to know so badly I'll give you the big reveal.

JASON

No... no! You're lying! It wasn't... I didn't...

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE
 (cold smile returns)
 Take a look for yourself.

Dewdrop gestures toward a dark corner near the bed,
 previously obscured. A large object covered by a dusty sheet.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE (CONT'D)
 The truth that you've been so
 desperate to find. Can you face it
 now?

Jason stares at the sheet, horror dawning. He knows what's
 under there. He shakes his head violently, scrambling
 backward, unable to look directly.

JASON
 (sobbing)
 No... No... it was an accident. GET
 IT AWAY!

His hand trembles violently as he pushes away.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE
 (detached)
 Still weak. Why don't you ask your
 little detective friend for help
 and make this fun. Maybe you two
 can team up and capture the big bad
 like you've always wanted too.
 Unless you're ready to admit you're
 not the hero of the story. His
 blood rests on your hands not mine.
 You just let me the dirty work so
 you could do what you do best. Run
 away.

Jason looks up, locking gaze directly in front of him -
 desperate, pleading, breaking the fourth wall

JASON
 (to audience, voice
 cracking.)
 Help me... Please... Can't you see
 this? Don't just sit there in the
 dark eating your popcorn.. Do
 something... Please... Help... He's
 right here... Can't anyone save
 me...

Dewdrop watches with cold amusement, then chuckles
 humorlessly. He turns slightly, also addressing audience.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE

(to audience)

Asking them for help? Oh that's rich. They can't help you, Jason. They just came to enjoy the spectacle that is Jason's pathetic life.

(turning to Jason)

There's no where left to run. Only one of us gets to walk out of here. So, face me or this is the end of the line for you.

Jason recoils, scrambling backward in anguish. As Jason trips backward, Dewdrop fires a finger gun directly at Jason. He turns his attention to the detective who has already shot a bullet moving towards his trajectory. He fires a retaliatory shot.

Jason's head crashes straight into the blue ceramic vase on the small table. His head cracks. The vase shatters.

FLASH MONTAGE (Rapid Cuts - 0.5 sec each):

- Uncle David's hand steadying the vase.
- Blue droplet on vanity mirror.
- Uncle David whispering "Jason, boundaries..."
- Half-burned photo under floorboard.
- Uncle David tries to comfort Jason. Jason rejects his comfort forcefully pushing him away and he trips and falls back.
- Uncle David lies at the bottom of the stairs, eyes open, blank. Faint blue reflection from a vase in his eye.

The Dewdrop figure closes his eyes at peace the bullet punctures his chest causing him to forcefully fly backwards. The detective figure clutches his chest.

Jason lies on floor, blood pooling under head amidst blue vase shards. Sheet partially pulled away, offering glimpse of Uncle David's face. Jason's backpack spills open. Framed polaroid photo of young Jason and Uncle David slides out, landing face up near Jason's still hand.

Jason looks up weakly, vision blurring. His gaze drifts to the spilled photo beside him.

A single tear rolls down Jason's eyes. The Dewdrop figure vanishes. Jason lies still, eyes staring blankly. Detective #1 also vanishes.

All that's left in the room is the spilled photo, shattered vase shards glinting, sheet edge covering body. Tight focus on immediate aftermath.

DEWDROP/BLUE SUIT FIGURE (CONT'D)
The Dewdrop... reveals...

FADE TO BLACK.

INT. CHEN FAMILY HOME - NIGHT (LATER)

An evidence bag is held by the gloved hand of OFFICER RODRIGUEZ. Inside, the polaroid photo of young Jason and Uncle David. Police lights flash faintly in the background reflecting off plastic. He fights back tears as he walks away from the scene.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. CHEN FAMILY KITCHEN - DAY (SEVERAL MONTHS LATER)

Sunlight streams into a familiar kitchen. Around the table sits Father Chen, Mother Chen, Eddie, Officer Rodriguez, Connor, Priya, Marcus, Annalise and Quinten.

On tables there are carefully cleaned shards of blue ceramic vase. Alongside: small bowls with lacquer, powered gold pigment, fine brushes - Kintsugi Repair Kit. A simple wooden urn sits respectfully to the side.

No one rushes. The process is slow, deliberate. Each joining line, soon gold traced.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Funny thing about the story of that dewdrop poet. He lived a very sad life. He actually wrote Dewdrop after he lost his daughter.

YOUNG JASON (V.O.)
That's so sad. Did he ever get to have a daughter?

Mother Chen carefully brushes gold lacquer along joined seam. Gold line gleams in the sunlight.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Well he did but sadly he passed and
didn't get too meet her.
Unfortunately, life doesn't always
go the way we want it go but there
is a silver lining. Do you know
what that is my little dewdrop.

Jason shakes his head

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Even though a dewdrop is here for
but a moment. The soil that was
nourished by the dewdrop remembers.

Eddie holds joined pieces steady while lacquer sets. He
glances at Annalise, silent acknowledgement passing between
them.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Though seemingly an insignificant
water drop by it's self. It's brief
moment can allow for greater things
to grow.

Father Chen successfully fits a piece into place. A
bittersweet look of sadness and relief flickers across his
face before settling back into stoicism.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Think about it one little poem
about a dewdrop allowed for a
moment of connection that's lasted
beyond him. I think that's
beautiful.

Quinten places his small shard on a table beside an urn.

UNCLE DAVID (V.O.)
Something tells me that your legacy
will be a similar one.

All of their hands work together on an emerging network of
golden lines crisscrossing a blue ceramic. The vase slowly
and painstakingly becomes whole again.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. ANNALISE'S APARTMENT - DAY (LATER)

Sunlight streams in. It feels quieter, tidier.

A small framed haiku hangs above the kitchen table.

"This dewdrop world-

Is a dewdrop world,

And yet, and yet...

- Kobayashi Issa

Annalise sits at the kitchen table. Small, tape recorder
before her, now silent.

She looks over at her laptop and opens to a fresh document.
Title: Glass Walls - Chapter 1. She begins typing, expression
focused.

We drift up past her focused face then continue toward the
window and ceiling, finally finding a single dust particle
caught in the sunbeam - mirroring the opening theatre image.

FADE TO BLACK.